

Lenseless Camera

Bell Labs brings a lenseless camera, a newly invented device with no lens and a single light sensitive sensor. <http://dgit.in/11RCkky>



Web Literacy Standard

Mozilla is about to launch the beta version of its Web Literacy Standard, a framework for learning on the Internet. <http://dgit.in/18JrAoF>

Apple iPhone 5: The benchmark that others strive to achieve

This was the phone that set the benchmark in build quality, till the HTC One came along. And not without good reason. The iPhone 5 marked a significant jump over the iPhone 4S. First up, the glass at the front and the back of the 4S weren't flush with the sides, but the iPhone 5 changed all that. The iPhone 4S weighed 140 grams (pretty much what modern phones do), but the iPhone 5 weighed just 112 grams. It was so light that anyone upgrading from a 4S found it disconcerting. The glass layer at the back gave way to an aluminium finish. The brushed look gives way to a shiny finish at the top and the bottom of the back panel. Back at the front, the Apple hallmark of one hardware key below the display remained as is. The volume rocker has individual up and down keys, on the left spine, with the toggle that can be set to put the phone in silent mode. The 4-inch display meant the iPhone 5 was taller vertically than the iPhone 4S, and the screen showed more lines of text at any given point of time.

HTC Butterfly: The prequel to the eventual HTC One

The Butterfly launched late last year in Japan (as the J Butterfly), landed in India only this year. And it was the phone that preceded the HTC One's launch. But, you could clearly see that the focus on design was of paramount importance to HTC. The Butterfly makes you sit up and take notice of the little things, and the big things. The biggest change over the Japanese version is the switch from the plastic to the soft touch polycarbonate at the back. We appreciate this change, because the rubberized finish at the back is immensely helpful when trying to deploy single hand operation on big screen phones.

We have seen how well HTC deploys the polycarbonate finish on the phones, particularly with the One X and the One X+, and the soft touch has been picked up from the HTC 8X. The Butterfly has the IPX-5 water resistance rating. According to the description of the rating - Protected against water jets - Water projected at all angles through a 6.3mm nozzle at a flow rate of 12.5 liters/min at a pressure of 30kN/m² for 3 minutes from a distance of 3 meters. Safe to say, the Butterfly would be able to handle the sharp rain shower as you run out of office towards the car, while talking on the phone.



Apple iPhone 5

PERFORMANCE

What good is an expensive phone that may look brilliant, but doesn't perform up to the mark? In this section, we analyse the performance of the phones, by comparing the benchmark scores as well as the real world usage performance.

LG Nexus 4 & LG Optimus G: The distant cousins

There is no shortage of power in the Nexus 4, powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 Pro quad-core processor and 2GB of RAM. But what makes the real difference is the completely pure Android experience that has gained the Nexus so many fans – something no other Android phone offers. With exactly the same power package, it is then a surprise that the Optimus G outscores the Nexus 4 in most of the benchmark tests. However, this neatly brings us to the point of real world usage, and this is where the Nexus 4 gets the better of the Optimus G. The untouched UI is slick, and even has the neat feature of accessing widgets on the lock screen itself. While the Optimus G's display is brighter, Nexus offers better text readability. The slight yellow-ish tinge, if you look closely, tends to skew the whites on both displays. The Nexus is the better deal, because of the better build, user experience and the lower price.

Nokia Lumia 920: Windows Phone's lone soldier

Windows Phone 8, as an OS, does have a lot going for it. The simplicity of the entire package is appealing to anyone who doesn't want to be overwhelmed by their smartphone. The Lumia 920, currently the most expensive WP device being sold in

India, has the power, performance and the personality to command that price. We have experienced Windows Phone working smoothly on fairly limited specifications, so it is correct to assume that it performs brilliantly on the powerful Lumia 920. The display, while not Full HD as some of its rivals, is still very good. Fast motion scenes work well, and text rendering is very good. Slightly reflective display, but still works well under bright sunlight. The crowning moment for the Lumia 920 is undoubtedly its camera, with brilliant low-light images that are pretty much unmatched by any other phone at the moment. However, Windows Phone still has a long way to go to match Android and iOS in terms of its app variety and quality. And if that matters to you, better consider another OS.

BlackBerry Z10 & BlackBerry Q10: BB10 is here to stay

BB10's UI is the best thing about all that is new, and the swipe gestures are very addictive and convenient. You can even swipe up on the screen, from the BlackBerry logo, and unlock the display. The right and left swipes to navigate a stacked UI are very workable. The BB10.1 OS, is a very smooth operating system. Even when the phone does fill up with lots of data over a period of time, there are no visible slow-downs. The Hub is a neat feature, which puts all notifications in one place. The same has been deployed on the full-touch Z10 and the touch + QWERTY combo on the Q10. The on-screen keyboard on the Z10 is designed to resemble the physical QWERTY on the Q10, and the bigger keys make the on-screen keyboard a lot more comfortable to use. The Z10's